



they complement each other?

Imagine strength training two or three times a week and then spending the rest of your active time doing something you genuinely enjoy. You may play a racquet sport twice a week, run on the weekend, walk every day, or train towards an event. Suddenly, fitness doesn't occupy one hour of your life. It becomes part of your life. And this is where I believe the definition of being fit also needs to evolve.

Having visible abs does not automatically mean someone is healthy. Neither does having bulging muscles. The way I look at fitness is much broader. Can your body produce strength when required? Can you move comfortably? Can you walk long distances without exhaustion? Can your heart and lungs handle physical demand? Can you recover well? Do you sleep well? Do you wake up with energy? Can you participate in life rather than constantly protect your body from it? That, to me, is fitness.

There is another fascinating dimension to this new movement culture: community. Human beings are social creatures. When movement is connected with other people, adherence changes dramatically. You are not simply going for a run anymore; you are meeting your group. You are not simply playing padel; you are meeting friends. You are not simply training; you are preparing together for an event. There is accountability without somebody constantly having to motivate you.

Of course, we must also be careful that fitness does not become only another form of social signalling. The clothes, clubs, events, and experiences can make movement exciting, but ultimately, our body doesn't care how fashionable the activity is. It responds to movement, resistance, recovery, nutrition, sleep, and consistency. So, use the culture, but don't lose the purpose. The objective is not to look like someone who lives a healthy lifestyle. The objective is to actually live one. And perhaps, that is the real new frontier of fitness.

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The gym is neither disappearing, nor should it. Strength training will continue to remain an extremely valuable tool for health, body composition, and longevity. But the gym is turning into one part of a much larger ecosystem of movement.

Your workout might happen under a barbell today, on a tennis court tomorrow, on a running track this weekend, and during a long evening walk with your family. That is how I would like people to start thinking about fitness.

Don't simply ask yourself, "Did I work out today?" Ask yourself, "How much did I move today?"

Because ultimately, the goal isn't to become someone who goes to the gym; it's to build a body that allows you to live fully, move freely, stay strong, and keep participating in life for as long as possible.

And if we can make movement enjoyable, social, and deeply integrated into the way we live, staying fit stops becoming something we constantly have to force ourselves to do. It simply becomes who we are. ■

Above, from left: Padel has become a popular community sport in India; group workouts at the gym are an interactive way to stay healthy and motivated

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